

Eco-Tourism Guide to Chilika Lake, Odisha

Asia's Largest Brackish Water Lagoon & Biodiversity Hotspot

Location & Overview

-  **Region:** Spanning Puri, Khurda & Ganjam districts
 -  **Area:** ~1,100 sq. km
 -  **Type:** Brackish water lagoon connected to the Bay of Bengal
 -  **Ramsar Site:** Recognized for ecological importance since 1981
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Biodiversity Highlights

Chilika is a paradise for nature lovers and wildlife enthusiasts.

Aquatic Life

- Irrawaddy dolphins (Satapada region)
- Over 225 fish species
- Crabs, prawns, mollusks

Avian Wonders

- 200+ bird species including:
 - Flamingos 
 - Herons 
 - Sea eagles 
-  Migratory birds from Siberia, Iran, and Central Asia
-  Best season: November to February

Terrestrial Fauna

- Blackbuck, golden jackals, spotted deer, hyenas
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Eco-Tourism Zones & Activities

 Zone	 Attractions	 Activities
Satapada	Dolphin watching, scenic boating	Eco-cruises, birding tours
Mangalajodi	Wetland bird paradise	Guided bird walks, canoe rides
Kalijai Island	Temple of Goddess Kalijai	Cultural immersion, sunrise views
Nalabana Island	Protected bird sanctuary (restricted)	Research, photography (with permit)
Rambha	Scenic islands (Honeymoon, Breakfast)	Nature camps, island hopping

Eco-Stays & Camps

Nature Camps

- Swiss tents with solar lighting
- Local cuisine & guided tours

OTDC Resorts

- Budget-friendly, government-run

Homestays

- Available in Mangalajodi & Satapada
 - Immersive village experiences
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Visitor Activities

-  Bird watching with local eco-guides
-  Dolphin spotting via silent boats
-  Nature photography & sketching
-  Cultural tours to artisan villages
-  Participate in clean-up drives

Responsible Travel Tips

-  Avoid plastic; carry reusable bottles & bags
-  Respect wildlife—no feeding or loud noises
-  Support local artisans & eco-guides
-  Stick to designated trails & boating zones
-  Engage in community-led conservation efforts

Getting There

 **Mode**  **Details**

 **Air** Bhubaneswar Airport (~120 km)

 **Rail** Puri, Balugaon, Rambha stations

 **Road** NH-16 & coastal roads to key zones